LINC Literacy in Community

The Journey to Fluency

Decoding

Decoding is the ability to sound out words. This process secures words in memory, eventually making them recognizable by sight.

Sight Recognition

Sight recognition is the process of recognizing words instantly and effortlessly. These words must be stored permanently in memory by connecting a word's spelling to it's letter sounds. Once a word is stored in memory, it can be read instantly or 'by sight' which leads to more fluent reading.

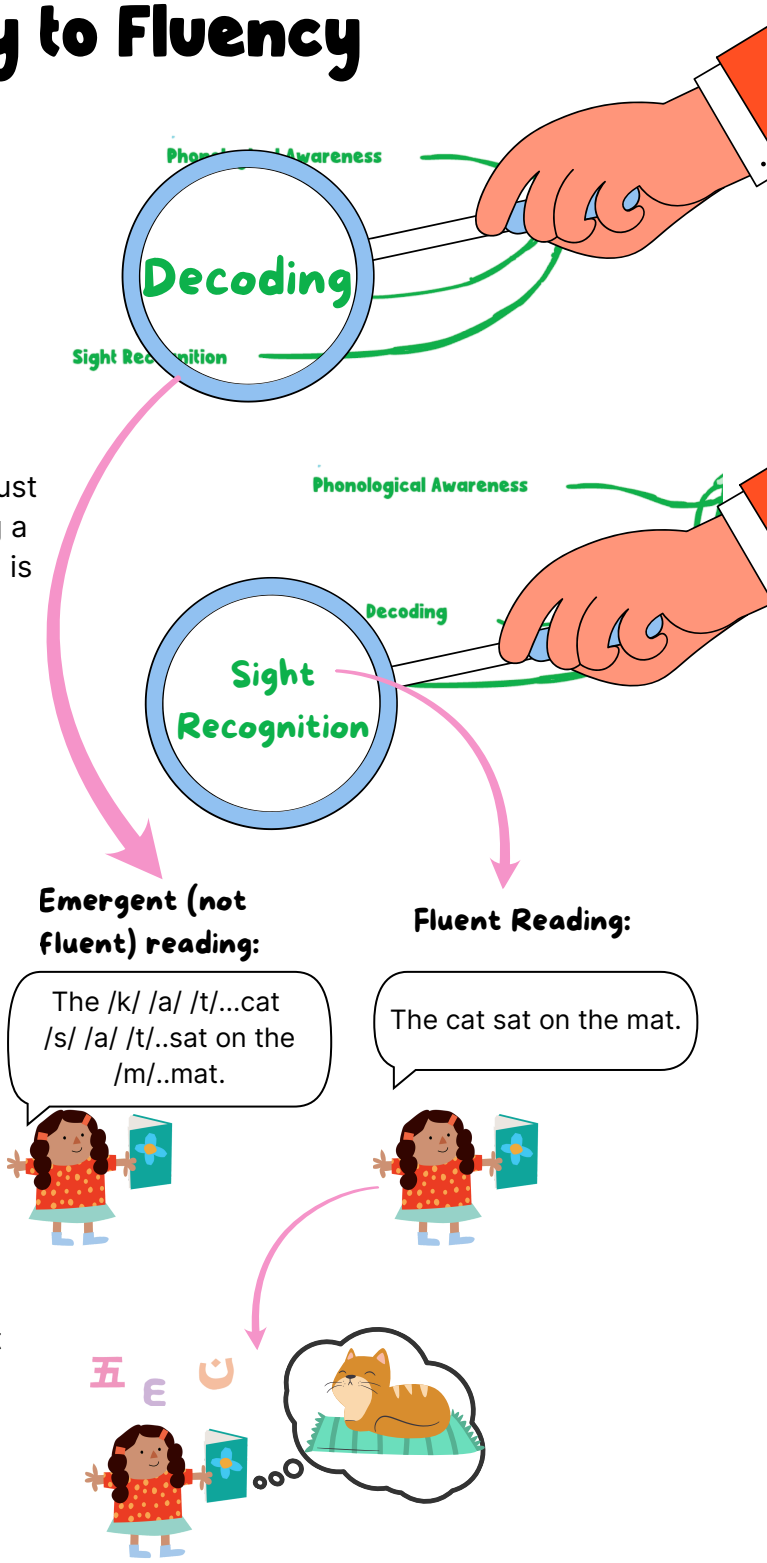
Fluency

Fluency is the ability to read aloud accurately, with speed and expression. Fluent reading sounds like talking. When reading sounds like talking, our brains can make a movie in our minds, just like when we listen to a story.

Fluency supports **comprehension**, because readers that spend less energy sounding out words can keep their focus on the meaning of the text.

Comprehension

Comprehension is the ability to understand what you read. This is the ultimate goal of reading.



Fluency Activities

To help your child build fluency, try using one of these routines next time you enjoy a book together.

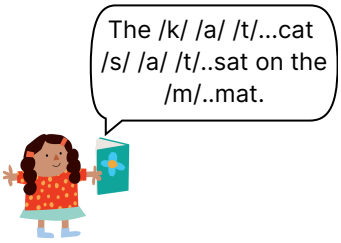
Read, Point, and Switch

1. Using a single shared book, child reads one page or less while adult (or a partner child) points to the words.

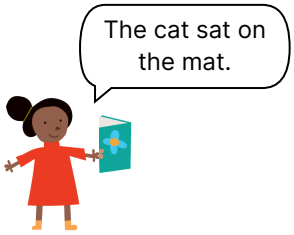
2. Whoever was the reader on the first page is now the pointer for the 2nd page. Continue taking turns in this fashion.

Repeated reading (with adult modeling)

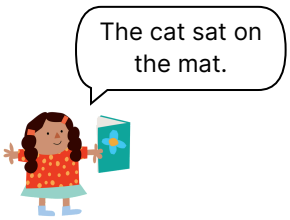
1. Child reads passage, taking as long as they need to decode words.



2. Adult reads same passage to model fluent reading while child listens.



3. Child reads the same passage again, trying to read words by sight (without sounding out) when possible.



Rhymes, Poems & Songs, Oh My!

Read aloud from texts that highlight the rhythm of speech, such as nursery rhymes, poems and song lyrics. This demonstrates fluent reading for your child (even if they are not the one reading) in a range of contexts.